allowed India to address the situation with resolve and quiet diplomacy.[21] India has never been a US ally and consequently does not fear abandonment. Last, on the issue of democracy, although India has historically championed principles such as self-determination, Third World solidarity, and anti-imperialism in the international system, it has fallen well short of endorsing values-based coalitions or projecting its own democratic credentials onto other countries by way of democracy promotion or – at the extreme – regime change. Like China and Russia, India remains wedded to Westphalian notions of absolute sovereignty that are largely incompatible with Western notions of humanitarian intervention, the responsibility to protect, or democracy promotion and regime change.[22]

The grand bargain

Balancing against China, compensating for US unreliability, and shared political values are inadequate explanations for India's interest in Japan. Instead, in order to understand the drivers of India's Japan policy, one has to take a longer and more modest view of what states in India's and Japan's respective positions can achieve in the face of a disadvantageous power balance. Two complementary logics drive the relationship from India's perspective: the first is that in order to be a credible long-term player in Asia, India needs to develop its hard-power capabilities, particularly in terms of a foundation that can sustain higher levels of economic and military power in the future. The second logic is that in order to credibly deter a rising China in any future scenario, India must invest in a minimum level of policy coordination and organisational interoperability with similarly placed countries such as Japan. Indian